



Lilah: The power of a visualization

My name is Lilah Jones, and

I am a part of our cloud team. I get a chance to lead a team of amazing

individuals that are focused on helping customers get to the cloud. Data visualizations,

that's a long word and that can also make your eyes glaze over. But I wonder if, when you were little and

you were with your parents, maybe they had a bedtime routine or

maybe you have children, you're doing a bedtime routine with them. You very rarely are going to come to

those children with a bunch of facts and figures before they go to bed. But I bet you probably are telling them

a story, you're showing them pictures, I know I always loved comic books,

pictures tell a story. Data visualizations are pictures,

they are a wonderful way to take very basic ideas around data and

data points and make them come alive. You can do all different types of

combinations of visualizations, but the ones that are interactive,

wow, those are huge. Can you imagine being executive of an

organization and trying to figure out how

should we open up another site in Bangkok? Does that make sense and

us being able to walk in and saying, here's why it makes sense in having

great data visualizations to support all of our points of view,

makes it a no brainer. Interestingly enough, I do recall

the first time I came across a super amazing visualization,

it was in my personal life. I switched my budgeting software from one provider to another, and the provider that I switched to was really focused on every dollar has a job and making sure you're budgeting, every single dollar. They gave visualizations that change, depending on what input you would add to it and it really just changed my entire perspective, the entire thing. So having the data is like having the answer sheet for a test, it really just lets you know that you're going to make good decisions because it's backed up by data.